# Abdullah Al Zahid

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## SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree and four years across GO rail service planning at Metrolinx and municipal transportation planning at the City of Toronto. Has assessed what construction restrictions do to an operating railway, simulated Ontario Line construction staging, and reviews consultant studies against standards.

## EXPERIENCE

### Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

*City of Toronto | January 2024 – present*

- Review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them against City standards and Official Plan policy, and recommend conditions where something is missing.
- Run assigned studies from scoping through to recommendations, writing the briefing notes that come out of them and presenting to planners, engineers and managers in other divisions.
- Coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and work issues through to a position everyone can act on.
- Built the Transportation Data Dashboard, replacing a report rebuilt by hand each quarter with one validated source the division reports from, and saw the change through to adoption.

### Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

*Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024*

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward.
- Assessed the service effect of temporary and permanent slow orders, the kind of restriction that construction on an operating railway imposes.
- Worked with schedulers, operations staff and engineers on service design decisions and presented the evidence behind them.
- Built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and produced summaries of speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.
- Set up a command line workflow so temporary and permanent slow orders could be pre-simulated in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours.

### Graduate Transportation Planner

*Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023*

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

### Graduate Research Assistant

*University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022*

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

## SKILLS

Operational impact assessment: OpenTrack rail simulation and Synchro traffic simulation of construction staging. Review of consultant studies and submissions against standards. AutoCAD and Civil 3D. Reports, briefings and presentations. Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL, ArcGIS Pro and QGIS. MS Office.

## EDUCATION

**MSc, Transportation Engineering** — University of Alberta, 2022

**BSc, Civil Engineering** — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

**BSc, Computer Science** — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)